

Scope Clarification and Preservation

Correspondence

Open Grid Proposal

Date: June 14, 2024 **Reference:** DOE-FOIA-2024-OG-041

Nila Quen writes for Open Grid Archive in response to the June 10 questions. Open Grid agrees that identical distributed copies may be deduplicated. The responsive unit should be the authoritative content of an approved edition, not each recipient's copy. A distribution or supersession log remains a separate record when it contains unique administrative information.

Open Grid also agrees to include a final tabletop exercise edition if the agency approved it as an edition and it was effective during the requested period. Participant notes, draft scenarios, comments, and unapproved alternatives remain outside the request. A quality-review map is included only if it was finalized and used to assess the approved suite; informal working diagrams are excluded.

Correspondence should be limited to a signed or otherwise final approval memorandum and a final supersession notice. Open Grid does not seek scheduling traffic, routine transmission, or deliberative exchanges. It continues to exclude incident-specific logs, raw alerts, configurations, diagrams of real infrastructure, access information, and personal contact details.

These concessions narrow the collection while preserving the requested final-version history. Open Grid asks ORER to confirm the effective-date method and to continue preserving the authoritative editions during processing.

Agency Confirmation Question

Date: June 18, 2024 **Agency reference:** CLR-OG-0621

Elian Voss acknowledges the June 14 proposal and asks one final question. ORER understands “effective during the requested period” to include an edition approved before January 1, 2022, only if that edition remained operative on or after that date. An edition approved after May 31, 2024, would be excluded even if it discussed an earlier edition. The office also understands that the final approval memorandum and supersession log are sought for each responsive family, but only one copy of a document common to several families is required.

ORER proposes the following search fields: title, controlled indexing term, effective date, supersession field, and custodian certification. Search terms will include Grid Sentinel and the three named playbook families. The office will use deduplication based on content and metadata, then ask custodians to distinguish final records from drafts.

Please confirm whether the time construction is correct. If it is, ORER will treat June 21 as the perfected-scope date for scheduling purposes while retaining June 3 as the original receipt date. No fee estimate is presently needed. The preservation notice remains active for likely final editions, approval records, and supersession logs.

Requester's Final Confirmation

Date: June 21, 2024 **From:** Nila Quen

Open Grid confirms the agency's effective-date construction. An edition qualifies when it was operative for any portion of January 1, 2022, through May 31, 2024. A record created later solely to discuss the period is not responsive. One authoritative copy of duplicated content is sufficient, and a common final approval record need not be reproduced more than once.

The agreed search fields and terms are acceptable as a starting point. A title-only search would be insufficient if a final record is indexed under a family name rather than the Grid Sentinel suite name, which is why Open Grid understands that ORER will use the title, controlled term, effective-date, and supersession fields together. Custodian review should resolve ambiguous candidates.

Open Grid does not concede that the clarification restarts any statutory period. The parties need not resolve that timing question to complete processing. The organization prefers a careful electronic production with usable context and is willing to receive the response after consultation if ORER provides a reasonable status update.

The preservation request is limited to records within the confirmed scope and ordinary metadata needed to identify finality, date, and version. It does not seek new records or forensic recovery. Tamsin Roe and Leo Marr may be copied if a further material narrowing is proposed.

Agency Scope Acceptance

Date: June 21, 2024 **From:** Elian Voss

ORER accepts the confirmed scope and will use it for request DOE-FOIA-2024-OG-041. Custodian assignment will begin June 24, and repository searches are scheduled to begin June 25. The office expects to search its fictional Beacon final-policy library, Driftglass superseded-version archive, and Harborline records correspondence store. Those names identify only synthetic repositories used in this exercise.

Responsive records will be limited to authoritative final editions, final exercise editions, a finalized quality-review map if one exists, final approval memoranda, and final supersession or distribution logs. Duplicates will be removed. Drafts, comments, routine correspondence, incident files, and the technical or personal categories expressly excluded by Open Grid will not enter the review set.

The preservation instruction now uses the same boundary. Ari Tern, fictional program manager, and Milo Crest, fictional records liaison, have been asked to preserve authoritative editions and unique governance records. The instruction does not authorize anyone to open a live system or collect operational data.

The office will provide a determination after search, deduplication, custodian review, and exemption review. It anticipates consulting Kira Morrow about record purpose and content. Open Grid will receive an electronic decision and, if records are released, a production manifest identifying the authoritative items reviewed.

Agreed Scope Matrix

The agreed universe contains four categories. Category A consists of final Operational Decision Trees; Category B consists of final Cyber-Incident Escalation Matrices; Category C consists of final Response-Coordination Appendices; Category D consists of unique final approval, supersession, and distribution records. A final tabletop edition or finalized quality-review map is placed in the corresponding substantive category, not treated as a draft.

The date test asks whether an approved edition was effective at any time from January 1, 2022, through May 31, 2024. The copy test retains one authoritative record when duplicates contain the same content. The correspondence test retains only a final approval or supersession instrument. The exclusion test removes drafts, comments, meeting traffic, actual incident material, raw telemetry, system configurations, source code, credentials, real-infrastructure diagrams, and personal contact fields.

Searches will combine controlled fields with the terms Grid Sentinel, Operational Decision Tree, Cyber-Incident Escalation Matrix, Response-Coordination Appendix, revision approval, and supersession. Custodian review will decide finality and responsiveness after automated collection. Reviewers will separately consider withholding, foreseeable harm, and segregability; the scope agreement does not predetermine any exemption.

Both correspondents accept this matrix as the reproducible search boundary. The agency reference is CLR-OG-0621. All institutions, repositories, people, and program names in the exchange are fictional.